
Assignment: Evaluating the Designation of Drug Cartels as Terrorist Organizations

Background:

In a significant departure from traditional counterterrorism policy, the Trump Administration has officially designated several international drug cartels—including Tren de Aragua and MS-13—as Foreign Terrorist Organizations (FTOs) and Specially Designated Global Terrorists (SDGTs). This policy shift reflects a broader redefinition of national security threats, expanding the scope of terrorism to include transnational criminal organizations involved in narcotics trafficking, violence, and destabilization across the Western Hemisphere.

Objective:

Conduct a critical analysis of this policy change using course materials and independent research. Your task is to assess whether the designation of drug cartels as terrorist organizations aligns with established frameworks for investigating and prosecuting foreign terrorism.

Instructions:

1. Research Component:

Investigate the Trump Administration's rationale for designating drug cartels as terrorist entities. Use credible sources such as government documents, academic articles, and reputable news outlets (see Reliable Resources presentation in Canvas) to understand the legal, strategic, and geopolitical implications of this shift.

2. Analytical Component:

Drawing on the theoretical frameworks and case studies presented in your textbook and course materials, evaluate the merits of this policy change. Consider the following:

- Does this designation align with traditional definitions and models of foreign terrorism?
- How might this impact law enforcement practices, intelligence operations, and international cooperation?

Submission Guidelines:

- Length: 1 page minimum, double-spaced (does not include cover page, half pages, or reference page)
 - Format: APA or Chicago style citations
 - NO AI!!!
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